

The Preuss School UC San Diego
La Jolla, California

812

The Midnight Mechanics

2027 Sponsorship Packet

FRC Team 812

Who we are

We are the Midnight Mechanics, Team 812 at The Preuss School UC San Diego. Our school serves low-income students who will be the first in their families to graduate from a four-year college. On our team, we learn engineering by building and competing together.

We need about $10,000 more to build our robot and travel to competitions in the 2027 season.

Team 812 started in 2001 and first competed in FIRST in 2002. FIRST lists us as San Diego's first FRC team. We design, machine, wire, and program our robots, with guidance from our mentors.



The Preuss School UC San Diego

25	51	5	1st
Seasons since 2001	Events competed	Championship trips	FRC team in San Diego

39 students and mentors · 24 fIRST awards · 16 seasons of public code

Mentors

Dan Rupert
Mechanical design

Mechanical design · CAD · Gear ratios

Dan O'Neill
Software and technology

Software · Engineering leadership · Analytics

Dave Harry
Mentor

Tom Lafleur
Mentor

Mr. Huang
Mentor

Big Jiawei



REBUILT · official record

24-19-0

In 2026 we built Big Jiawei for REBUILT. We finished with a 24-19-0 record. We captained playoff alliances at both district events and competed at the FIRST California Southern State Championship in Anaheim.

CA District San Diego
Rank 8 · 10-6-0 · Alliance 6 captain

CA District San Gabriel Valley
Rank 7 · 9-6-0 · Alliance 5 captain

Southern State Championship
Rank 38 · 5-7-0 · Anaheim

Building for competition

In FIRST Robotics Competition, a new game is announced in January. We design and build a robot to play it, then test and improve it as we prepare for competitions.

- Design, machine, wire, and program our robot
- Learn from engineers and teachers in the shop
- Use engineering tools and share our code on GitHub
- Compete at district events and work toward states

Why 812

You are funding a student-run engineering program.

The Preuss School serves low-income students who will be first in their families to finish college. For many students, Team 812 is their first chance to use engineering tools and work with mentors.

Our robot code is public.

Sixteen seasons of robot code are public on GitHub, along with two tools we built ourselves. Engineers can inspect how we build and test.

We have been building in San Diego since 2001.

Team 812 is San Diego's first FRC team. We have competed in 51 events and made five trips to the World Championship. Your sponsorship helps keep that student-run program going.

2018	2016	2017	2019
Orange County Regional Winner	**Regional Chairman's Award**	**Regional Engineering Inspiration Award**	**Woodie Flowers Finalist Award**

Our 2027 funding gap

$10,000

Working estimate

Help us close our $10,000 funding gap for 2027. Your support helps pay for robot parts, competition fees, and transportation. You can also help by mentoring or donating parts and tools.

How we'll use your support

Registration and event fees	$4,000
Robot parts and materials	$3,000
Travel to competitions	$3,000
Total	**$10,000**

How to give

Donations to Team 812 are administered through the UC San Diego Foundation, a 501(c)(3) nonprofit. Give at team812.com, or email us and we will send the gift link. The amounts shown here estimate how we would use the additional $10,000 we are raising.

UC San Diego Foundation, EIN 95-2872494.

Need an invoice or W-9? Email us.

To offer parts, tools, shop time, or mentoring, email us.

Sponsor tiers

Each tier includes the benefits below it. Gifts under $1,000 are recognized at the Supporter level.

Midnight

$5,000

Includes the $2,500 benefits, plus

- Logo decal **on the robot**
- Logo on team shirts
- Robot demo at your office
- Logo on our website's homepage

Starlight

$2,500

Includes the $1,000 benefits, plus

- Logo decal **on the robot**
- Logo on team shirts
- Thank-you post on our social accounts

Twilight

$1,000

- Logo on the pit banner
- Logo on our sponsors page
- Thank-you letter from the team

Current sponsors

Qualcomm · Nordson · leidos · BAE SYSTEMS · Sciences Education Foundation, General Atomics

Email
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Site
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Instagram
@midnightmechanics